



禮

Li is the virtue of correct behavior and propriety.

仁

Ren is the virtue of charity and humanity.

義

Yi is the virtue of honesty and integrity.

孝

Zhi is the virtue of knowledge and learning.

信

Xin is the virtue of faithfulness and loyalty.

By the way...

my real name is K'ung Ch'iu, but my followers called me "K'ung Fu-tzu" (Great Master K'ung), which became Confucius in the west.



During his travels around China, Confucius attracted a following of students and disciples.

Leading by example

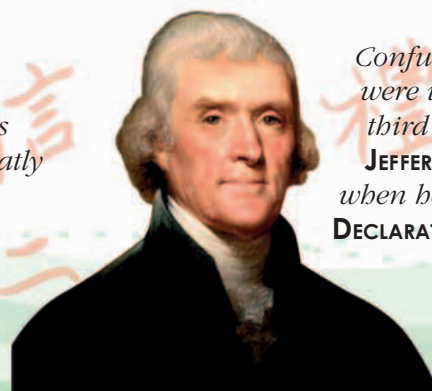
Confucius realized that government **corruption was everywhere**. Rulers did as they pleased, even testing new weapons on their servants. He developed a new moral code, called the "**FIVE VIRTUES**." He believed that for a society to be happy and prosperous, you need a good government run by good officials. He left his post as an official and spent 12 years traveling, teaching, and gathering students and disciples. He became a minister in the state of Lu, and used his methods to virtually **eliminate crime** and unrest.

The accidental religion

By 136 BCE, Confucius's teachings became the state religion of China, known as Confucianism. For more than 2,000 years all Chinese officials had to pass an exam based on his ideas. Even today, many of the world's governments and religions are still influenced by his philosophies.



The Chinese philosopher and scholar **Zhu Xi** (1130–1200 CE) updated and added to the ideas behind Confucianism, and greatly **INFLUENCED CHINESE GOVERNMENT**.



Confucius's philosophies were used by America's third president **THOMAS JEFFERSON** (1743–1826) when he drafted America's **DECLARATION OF INDEPENDENCE**.